

Nathaniel Nelson

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Executive Portfolio: NathanielNelsonD.com

Supply Chain and Transformation Leader with 13+ years of experience driving large-scale transformation across planning, inventory, supplier performance, customer experience, and operational strategy. Proven track record delivering \$100M+ in enterprise value through supply chain optimization, governance modernization, working capital improvement, and technology-enabled process transformation. Experienced leading cross-functional teams, executing complex enterprise programs, influencing executive stakeholders, and building scalable operating models across multi-billion-dollar retail and eCommerce organizations.

-----AREAS OF EXPERTISE-----

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS	Strategic Planning Supply Chain Transformation Enterprise Value Creation Capital Allocation Executive Stakeholder Management Working Capital Optimization Vendor Engagement Strategy Cost-to-Serve Optimization Operating Model Design Organizational Leadership
TECHNICAL SKILLS	SQL Tableau Jira Confluence Snowflake KNIME SAP Python (Automation) Vertica WMS ETL Pipelines Data Warehousing Forecasting & Predictive Analytics AI Tools: Cursor/Claude

-----PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE-----

Senior Program Manager, Returns, Refunds & Concessions (RRC), Chewy | Fort Lauderdale **05/2026 - Current**
Lead enterprise entitlement governance across refunds, replacements, concessions, and discounts & adjustments (D&A), partnering across Product, Customer Care, Finance, Operations, Engineering, and Analytics to translate policy into scalable customer outcomes. Own decision frameworks, operational controls, and automated entitlement logic that improve policy adherence, reduce discretionary spend, and enable consistent execution across agent-assisted and self-service experiences.

- Lead the development of enterprise entitlement frameworks, policy guardrails, escalation paths, and operational controls supporting consistent customer outcomes and financial stewardship.
- Partner with Product, Engineering, and Analytics teams to operationalize policy requirements through scalable workflows, system capabilities, and automated decisioning solutions that improve execution quality and reduce manual intervention.
- Establish performance management mechanisms and reporting processes providing visibility into entitlement utilization, policy adherence, discretionary spend, override activity, and customer experience trends.
- Drive root-cause analysis and resolution of complex operational scenarios across Dropship, Pharmacy, Third-Party (3P), and other specialized fulfillment channels, developing scalable operating models that balance customer experience, operational efficiency, and cost management.

Senior Program Manager, Head of Vendor Performance and Compliance, Chewy | Fort Lauderdale **08/2024 – 05/2026**
Accountable for supplier performance, compliance, and operational governance across 3,000+ vendors, 20,000+ SKUs, and 13 distribution centers, ensuring supply chain reliability and scalable growth across Chewy's fulfillment network. Lead a cross-functional team spanning program management, business engineering, and analytics, overseeing EDI, supplier onboarding, systems integration, and product readiness. Own strategic planning, operating model design, and enterprise transformation initiatives focused on service, cost, and operational excellence.

- Transformed vendor compliance operating model into a data-driven performance and enterprise value engine, generating \$20M in annual value, improving labor productivity by 15%, reducing vendor defect rates by 30%+, and lowering cost-to-serve across fulfillment operations.
- Launched a net-new enterprise chargeback platform across 10 defect categories, modernizing legacy processes into a scalable SPARK-enabled solution that generated \$12M in annual revenue and delivered measurable ROI through automation, standardization, and defect reduction.
- Drove measurable vendor performance gains through expanded compliance metric adoption, increasing EDI (855/856) compliance by 15%, improving carrier OTIF by 5%, and raising packaging and dunnage compliance by 8%.
- Led 100+ executive-level vendor collaboration reviews, influencing \$30M+ in strategic capital allocation decisions across automation, equipment investments, quality controls, and process modernization initiatives.
- Standardized governance and execution across 24 compliance specialists enterprise-wide, driving 30% improvement in logging performance, 15% in task prioritization, and 10% in data accuracy; introduced enhanced root-cause taxonomy and vendor-facing reporting to accelerate defect resolution and improve long-term performance.
- Managed and developed a high-performing, cross-functional team of 6 (PMs, BIEs, BIAs), implementing a scalable operating model with defined decision rights and quarterly OKRs tied to executive white papers and annual strategic priorities, driving accelerated execution and measurable enterprise outcomes.

Senior Program Manager, CPFR and Supply, Chewy | Denver, CO**03/2022 – 08/2024**

Built and scaled Chewy's enterprise CPFR program, integrating demand planning, supply planning, replenishment, supplier collaboration, and S&OP/S&OE into a unified planning framework. Established forecasting, inventory, and supplier governance processes while developing planning tools, operating mechanisms, and executive decision forums that improved service levels, working capital efficiency, and execution quality across the supply chain.

- Drove enterprise-wide optimization of vendor production planning and replenishment, improving service levels while reducing working capital requirements, delivering 5%+ OOS reduction, 4% location-level OOS reduction, and \$10M+ in optimized savings.
- Led monthly vendor performance reviews integrating supply and demand data; built API-driven data sharing and automated reporting pipelines (8+ reports), enabling real-time insights and driving 40%+ efficiency gains.
- Built and deployed 10+ Tableau dashboards paired with SOPs and operating playbooks, translating complex supply and demand signals into repeatable, decision-ready workflows adopted across planning and vendor teams.
- Created and institutionalized Non-Optimal Placement (NOP), a net-new supply chain metric adopted as a top-five enterprise KPI, providing visibility into inventory deployment inefficiencies, improving working capital utilization, and enabling exception-based management that accelerated decision cycles by 20%+.

Supply Chain Manager, T-Mobile | Seattle, WA**08/2019 – 03/2022**

Owned end-to-end supply planning and inventory management of the \$1.5B Apple portfolio supporting 7,000+ retail locations and 1,000+ SKUs. Led demand and supply planning, inventory optimization, supplier collaboration, risk mitigation, systems transformation, and executive decision-making to support new product launches, merger integration, and service level performance across the largest wireless retailer in North America.

- Directed inventory strategy, demand signal management, and replenishment planning for the Apple portfolio, achieving a 2% Retail Stock Out rate against a 3% target, avoiding \$80M in inventory exposure, optimizing working capital deployment, and influencing leadership to cancel \$60M in purchase orders while exceeding financial write-down targets by \$1.6M.
- Led supply planning, capacity management, and launch readiness for the largest Apple NPI in company history, orchestrating over \$1B in product launches while aligning Procurement, Operations, Logistics, Retail, and Executive Leadership to ensure inventory availability and service level attainment.
- Established supplier risk mitigation and business continuity strategies during COVID-19 supply constraints, partnering with Procurement and Apple to manage capacity limitations, portfolio prioritization, allocation planning, and executive scenario modeling to protect revenue and customer experience.
- Served as a key leader in the Sprint merger integration and enterprise planning transformation, overseeing the migration of 3,000+ retail locations from JDA to SAP/ECC, enhancing replenishment processes, reporting governance, inventory visibility, and planning system capabilities while leading multiple technology and process improvement initiatives.

Senior Operations Analyst, PepsiCo | Dallas, TX**03/2018 – 08/2019**

Responsible for operations and logistics for 5 major markets and provided oversight to locations and team members for the collection, analysis, evaluation and reporting of T/L activities (e.g. performance metrics, SLAs, scorecards, cost models, P/L, etc.). Drove sales pilot program to analyze NAN sales in Torrance, CA which resulted in a 40% growth in revenue.

- Successfully reduced operation annual expenses by 10% or \$1.2 million by leading cost reduction and productivity initiatives, fleet management, and enhancement features.
- Effectively built DRT reports to improve ADAS to 90% and above for Q1 and Q2 of 2019. Instituted new FSV standards to increase volume by 20% from PY and cascaded to the analyst teams.
- Leveraged Tableau to communicate dashboards to senior leadership on operations KPI categories: P/L metrics, Payload Productivity, Off Day Orders, Manifest Compliance, Under Minimums, Delivery in Full to meet EOY targets.
- Coordinated and advised a multi-million dollar initiative to convert Torrance, CA to GEO system. Worked with the delivery team, S&D Ops, Sales team, and the Market Director to achieve the first successful Go-Live of the California region (Received W2G Award from the Market Director).

Supply Chain Analyst, PepsiCo | Denver, CO**2015 – 2018****Field/Warehouse Inventory Analyst, Kasco | St. Louis, MO****2014 – 2015****Transportation and Logistics Analyst, Anheuser-Busch | St. Louis, MO****2013 – 2014**

EDUCATION

B.S in Business Administration and Economics, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville, 2013